kwtSMS

API Documentation

HTTP/REST (JSON)/SMTP

2025/12/17 - v4.1

kwtSMS | YOU SEND WE DELIVER

Table of Contents

1. Requirements
2. Register Account
3. Features
4. Must Know Information ***
5. HTTP API
    a. balance
    b. senderid
    c. dlr
    d. send
    e. coverage
    f. status
    g. validate
6. REST API
    a. balance
    b. senderid
    c. dlr
    d. send
    e. coverage
    f. status
    g. validate
7. SMTP API
8. Error Codes
9. Implementation Best Practices ***
10. FAQs
11. Sample Code
12. Change Log

IMPORTANT SECURITY CONSIDERATIONS

Always use SSL (https) enabled links or URLs
SSL will encrypt your traffic and protect you from eavesdropping and information stealing.

Always use HTTP POST method never use GET
When you use HTTP GET method, all your data including usernames and passwords are logged by the server in clear text even if you use SSL.

Do not hardcode usernames and passwords into the code
Allow the client the freedom and ease to change his/her password anytime they wish. Especially important in case of the password compromised.

***** Very important must read**

Requirements for kwtSMS API:

1. You must have internet connection to connect to our website/software/app.
2. You must have an active account in kwtSMS.com.
3. Your kwtSMS.com account must be setup to use the API, after setup you will find API username and password in your kwtSMS account.
4. You can change API Password from your kwtSMS account after login.

API Use
You need API **username** and API **password** for API calls
Do not use your mobile number as username, it will not work!
You can find it in your kwtSMS.com account API page, after it is enabled

New Account Registration:

1. Goto our website: www.kwtsms.com
2. Click on Signup or Register
3. Activate your account with OTP message (if you did not get the activation message contact us)
4. Request API functionality from your account API menu.
5. We will get your account ready ASAP and send you confirmation. Then you can start testing and integration with your website/software/app.
6. For support and help contact us using one of the methods on our website (eMail,whatsapp,phone)

kwtSMS API Features:

1. Send messages to Kuwait (Zain, Ooredoo, STC, Virgin) or outside Kuwait.
2. The ability to send up to 200 numbers at a time.
3. Send in English or Arabic (Windows or UTF8 encoding) or in Unicode. No need for conversion.
4. All messages will be logged in your KwtSMS.com account for reporting.
5. You can check your account balance and available sender-ids.
6. You can pull delivery reports of your sent messages when they are available.
7. You can send long messages up to 6 pages in length.
   (1 Arabic message = 70 characters. 1 English message = 160 characters)
8. You should always use SSL encryption for security and privacy (HTTPS).
9. API lockdown feature. API will only accept requests from whitelisted IP addresses. This adds extra layer of security for your API.
10. API error-log in account page, to easily troubleshoot integration issues with your application.

Must Know Information

IMPORTANT USAGE INFORMATION

Using our promotional senderid (KWT-SMS) is for testing only

SMS delivery speed for this senderid is SLOW, 100 seconds or more, this is intentional by us

No delivery to Virgin numbers or blacklisted/blocked numbers

To ensure FASTER delivery and avoid delays especially for OTP and Virgin number, each customer must buy/register a private senderid

Links in Messages

Most countries have link filtering to protect their users from fraud

Messages with links to international countries, might get blocked

You can send messages with links in Kuwait, no problem

Sending Speed and Rate Limits

You can send 5 requests per second, maximum

If you exceed this limit, your IP will be blocked automatically

International Coverage

By default, international gateway is disabled. If needed, contact us to activate

Server Timezone

Asia/Kuwait GMT+3

HTTP API

IMPORTANT NOTE

HTTP Headers for Content-Type and Accept must be set to: **text/html**
HTTP Method: **POST**

Balance command:

This command is used to retrieve the account balance and total purchased credits. Please note that every time you send a message, the API returns the balance. No need to request the balance every minute.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/balance/

Balance parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API Username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password

Sample output:
181.00/1000.00

[Current Balance / Total Purchased Credits]

Senderid command:

This command is used to retrieve all available senderids that can be used in the (send) command.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/senderid/

Senderid parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API Username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password

Sample output:
KWT-SMS
KWT-TEST

API Use
You need API **username** and API **password** for API calls
Do not use your mobile number as username, it will not work!
You can find it in your kwtSMS.com account API page, after it is enabled

DLR command:

Retrieve the delivery reports for an already sent **international** messages only, (Kuwait messages does not have delivery reports). Do not request immediately after sending the message, wait at least 5 minutes before checking. When requesting many reports, add delay between requests so you don't get blocked.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/dlr/

DLR parameters:

Variable	Type	Max	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password
msgid	Alphanumeric	32	Yes	This is a unique msgid that was generated previously by the API when you sent the message. So, if you want to check for delivery reports you must save the message id in your database.

Sample: output:
xxxxxxxx,Blacklisted
xxxxxxxx,Delivered to mobile

Send command:

This command is used to send SMS messages.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/send/

Send parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password
sender	Alphanumeric	11	Yes	Use your private senderid. SenderID is case sensitive.
mobile	Numeric	2500	Yes	',' comma separated, no '+' or '00' or '.' or space in numbers, English only (1,2,3,..)
message	Alphanumeric	-	Yes	use "\n" for new lines, no html or emoji
test	Numeric	1	No	1 or 0: If set, messages will not be sent to handsets, but will be inserted in the queue and can be deleted to recover the credits. This way you can will save testing credits.

Sample output:
OK:f4c841adee210f31307633ceaebff2ec:1:1:180:1242667894

Field list in order separate by colon:
RESULT:MSG-ID:NUMBERS:POINTS-CHARGED:BALANCE-AFTER:UNIX-TIMESTAMP

Coverage command:

This command is used to retrieve available destinations (countries) that are active on your account to send messages to.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/coverage/

Coverage parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API Username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password

Sample: output:

965
971

Status command:

This command is for retrieving the status of your sent message: in queue (pending), in queue (error) or sent to gateway. This is not a delivery report.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/status/

Status parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password
msgid	Alphanumeric	32	Yes	This is a unique msgid that was generated previously by the API when you sent the message. So, if you want to check for delivery reports you must save the message id in your database.

Sample: output:

OK:Sent

Validate command:

This command is for validating phone numbers before sending or in bulk.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/validate/

Validate parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password
mobile	numeric	2500	Yes	',' comma separated, no '+' or '00' or '.' or space in numbers, English only (1,2,3,..)

Sample: output:

ER:+99220322
ER:0096599220322
ER:96524817066
NR:966558724477
OK:96599220322

ER = Error , NR = No route, OK= Good nuumber

REST/JSON API

IMPORTANT NOTE

HTTP Headers for Content-Type or Accept must be set to: **application/json**
HTTP Method: **POST**

Balance command:

This command is used to retrieve the account balance and total purchased credits. Please note that every time you send a message, the API returns the balance. No need to request the balance every minute.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/balance/

Balance parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API Username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password

Sample input payload:
{"username":"myuser", "password":"mypass" }

Sample output:
{"result":"OK","available":150,"purchased":1000}

Senderid command:

This command is used to retrieve all available senderids that can be used in the (send) command.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/senderid/

Senderid parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API Username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password

Sample input payload:
{"username":"myuser", "password":"mypass" }

Sample output:
{"result":"OK","senderid":["KWT-SMS","KWT-TEST"]}

Sample JSON Error output:

{"result": "ERROR", "code": "ERR003", "description": "Authentication error, username or password are not correct."}

DLR command:

Retrieve the delivery reports for an already sent **international** messages only, (Kuwait messages does not have delivery reports). Do not request immediately after sending the message, wait at least 5 minutes before checking. When requesting many reports, add delay between requests so you don't get blocked.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/dlr/

DLR parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password
msgid	Alphanumeric	32	Yes	This is a unique msgid that was generated previously by the API when you sent the message. So, if you want to check for delivery reports you must save the message id in your database.

Sample input payload:
{"username":"myuser", "password":"mypass", "msgid":'xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx' }

Sample: output:
{"result":"OK","report":[{"Number":"xxxxxxxx","Status":"Received by recipient"}]}

Send command:

This command is used to send SMS messages.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/send/

Send parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password
sender	Alphanumeric	11	Yes	Use your private senderid. SenderID is case sensitive.
mobile	Numeric	2500	Yes	',' comma separated, no '+' or '00' or '.' or space in numbers, English only (1,2,3,..)
message	Alphanumeric	-	Yes	use "\n" for new lines, no html or emoji
test	Numeric	1	No	1 or 0: If set, messages will not be sent to handsets, but will be inserted in the queue and can be deleted to recover the credits. This way you can will save testing credits.

Sample input payload:
{ "username":"myuser", "password":"mypass", "test":"1", "sender":"KWT-SMS", "mobile":"96599220322,96599220322", "message":"عربي+ تجربة" }

Sample output:
{"result":"OK","msg-id":"f4c841adee210f31307633ceaebff2ec","numbers":1,"points-charged":1,"balance-after":180,"unix-timestamp":1684763355}

Coverage command:

This command is used to retrieve available destinations (countries) that are active on your account to send messages to.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/coverage/

Coverage parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API Username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password

Sample input payload:
{"username":"myuser", "password":"mypass" }

Sample output:
{"result":"OK","prefixes":["965","971"]}

Status command:

This command is for retrieving the status of your sent message: in queue (pending), in queue (error) or sent to gateway. This is not a delivery report.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/status/

Status parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password
msgid	Alphanumeric	32	Yes	This is a unique msgid that was generated previously by the API when you sent the message. So, if you want to check for delivery reports you must save the message id in your database.

Sample input payload:
{"username":"myuser", "password":"mypass", "msgid":'xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx' }

Sample: output:
{"result":"OK","status":"sent","description":"Message successfully sent to gateway"}

Sample JSON Error output:

{"result": "ERROR", "code": "ERR003", "description": "Authentication error, username or password are not correct."}

Validate command:

This command is for validating phone numbers before sending or in bulk.

URL: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/validate/

Validate parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password
mobile	numeric	2500	Yes	',' comma separated, no '+' or '00' or '.' or space in numbers, English only (1,2,3,..)

Sample input payload:

{"username":"myuser", "password":"mypass", "mobile":'0096598765432,+96598765432,965' }

Sample: output:


```
{"result": "OK","mobile": {
                "ER": ["99220322","0096599220322","96524817066","9651800555"],
                "NR": ["966558724477"],
                "OK": ["96599153258","96599220322"]
        }
}
```


ER = Error , NR = No route, OK= Good nuumber

SMTP API

We encourage using the normal HTTP API to send SMS but in some scenarios and implementations, servers do not have direct internet access, so this is helpful to send SMS for computers behind firewall or closed network.

Needless to say, using this method is very **insecure** as emails travel though the internet in plain text and not encrypted. This could lead to credentials leak and account compromise.

Send email to: **sms@kwtsms.com**

The email content type should be **Text**, and not Rich text or HTML.

eMail Parameters:

Variable	Type	#Chrs	Mandatory	Description
username	Alphanumeric	15	Yes	API username
password	Alphanumeric	30	Yes	API password
sender	Alphanumeric	11	Yes	Use your private senderid or one of ours. SenderID is case sensitive.
mobile	Numeric	2500	Yes	',' comma separated, no '+' or '00' or '.' or space in numbers, English only (1,2,3,..)
message	Alphanumeric	-	Yes	use "\n" for new lines, no html or emoji

eMail body sample:
username:xx2xxx
password:xx3xxx
sender:SenderID
mobile:96597119220,96566074414
lang:1
text:Meet me at Starbucks!

The email subject is ignored. The parameter value should be in the same line.

NOTE: If there is anything wrong with your email or parameters or balance your message will not be sent and you **will not** get error message.

Error Codes

Code	Function	Description
ERR001	ALL	API off
ERR002	ALL	Username or Password or other required parameters are missing
ERR003	ALL	Wrong username or password
ERR004	ALL	Your account does not have API access
ERR005	ALL	Your account has been blocked
ERR006	send	No valid numbers submitted
ERR007	send	Cannot send more than 200 numbers at a time
ERR008	send	The senderid chosen is banned
ERR009	send	Message parameter is empty
ERR010	send	Your account balance is zero
ERR011	send	Not enough balance to send this message
ERR012	send	Cannot send more than 6 page messages, message is too long
ERR013	send	Your queued messages reached 1000, wait and try again
ERR019	dlr	No reports found
ERR020	dlr	Message does not exist
ERR021	dlr	Message does not have delivery report
ERR022	dlr	Delivery reports are not ready. Check back after 24 hours
ERR023	dlr	Unknown error Could not get delivery reports
ERR024	ALL	API Lockdown is ON and IP address not in the allowed list
ERR025	send	No valid numbers found, must be digits only with country code, cannot not include any characters like: +, 00, (), - , or space
ERR026	send	No route found for this number, country not activated, contact us to add destination country to your account
ERR027	send	HTML tags not allowed
ERR028	send	Must wait 15 seconds before sending a message to same number again
ERR029	status	Message does not exist or the msgid is wrong
ERR030	status	Message stuck in queue with error (delete to recover credits)
ERR031	send	Bad language detected, send rejected
ERR032	send	Spam message detected, send rejected
ERR033	coverage	No active coverage on your account, contact us to add one

Implementation Best Practices

1. Always use HTTPS and POST method for security

SSL will encrypt your traffic and protect you from eavesdropping and information stealing.
When you use HTTP GET method, all your data including usernames and passwords are logged by the server in clear text even if you use SSL. **Avoid adding user/pass in URLs** like this: https://www.kwtsms.com/API/send/?username=X&password=X <= **Don't do this. Very bad!**

2. Do not hard code the username/password into your code

Allow the client the freedom and ease to change his/her password anytime they wish. Especially important in case of the password compromised. Add settings variables to your app.

3. Test sending messages in English and Arabic before handoff

Test sending in both languages in case the client tries to use one of them. Otherwise, the message will be unreadable (gibberish).

4. When sending OTP include the app name in the messages

To comply with telecom rules, OTP and critical notifications must include the application/company name for security reasons. Example: **Your OTP for APPNAME is: 12345**

5. When sending OTP allow 3 minutes before SMS resend

First, make sure you are using Transactional Private SenderID for faster OTP delivery. Give the user room to receive and find the SMS, then copy paste the code. Not all users are computer wizards. Official KNET payment gateway allows 4 minutes before expiration.

6. User input sanitization, especially mobile numbers

Make sure the mobile numbers are correctly formatted and in international format, **remove + or 00** and add country code if the user did not. Otherwise, the API will not accept your message.
Numbers must be in English (1,2,3,..). Arabic/Hindi numbers will not be accepted.
Clean your text messages from emojis and special characters. Otherwise, it will get stuck in the queue and will not be sent.

7. No need to call /balance/ function after each send

When you do successful send, the API already returns how many points charged and the balance after sending. We also have low balance notifications for each API account.

8. Stop bots or automation tools

Always, check for bots or automation tools, use captcha or similar solutions to protect your signup or login form.

9. Enforce rate limits

Implement IP and phone numbers signup limits by time to prevent signup abuse and balance drainage. Computers never gets tired or trying to guess your login credentials unless you stop them and add protection measures and checks.

10. Delay between requests

Add a timer or delay between API requests to avoid automatic firewall blocking. You can do 5 requests per second maximum. We recommend maximum of 2 requests per second.

Frequently Asked Questions – FAQs

I always get this error "Username or password is wrong" even though I am sure I enter the correct username/password?!

This happens if you are using GET request and your password contains special characters like # or & or ? . To fix this, change the request method from GET to **POST** or change your password. **Always use HTTPS** in both methods. Also, make sure that your **username is not your account/mobile number**.

How to add new lines in text messages?

Try using "\n" for new lines.

I sent a message credits deducted and message not received!?

Please follow the steps below before you contact us:

1. Check the Sending Queue, your message could be stock for some reason, delete it and your account will be credited back.
2. Did you remember to set the variable test=0 ?
3. Check the Archive, if your message is NOT in the Archive that means you did not send it.
4. Check the numbers, open the message from the Archive and make sure the numbers are in the list and correct.
5. Note that some numbers can be blacklisted/filtered by the owner request.
6. Rarely, a delay happens due to marketing campaigns or busy seasons.
7. If the number is in DND list (blacklist) and you are using promotional senderid, your message will be filtered (not delivered).
8. Still need help? contact us with the following information: Name, Account, MessageID, Time&Date of message, Message Text.

When I send a message the senderid is always KWT-SMS, why?

This is the default test/promotional senderid. The system will use it if you did not buy your own private senderid. You must set your senderid exactly same case as it appears on your account. The senderid is **case sensitive**. So **Kuwait** is NOT same as **kuwait** or **KUWAIT**.

Why delivery reports are not ready?

Delivery reports (DLR) usually take 24 hours to be updated. It is worth mentioning that after Kuwait implemented mobile number portability (MNP) the delivery reports will not be accurate. So they are not to be relied on to measure SMS campaign effectiveness or link open rate.

What is Blacklist number? and how to fix it?

Blacklists (DND list) are filters put by the telecom company to protect their customers from spam and advertising. The owner of the number asks his telecom company to be on this list, then he will not receive any messages unless from whitelisted SenderIDs. Only the owner of the number can ask to be removed from the list by calling his telecom company.

How to Whitelist my SenderID for OTP?

If you send critical activation & notification messages and need them to be delivered to everyone even Blacklisted numbers, then you must apply for whitelisting your SenderID. Prepare a request with your company letterhead and send it to us, we will take care of the rest.

I cannot open your website it seems down?

Maybe our server is down (unlikely) OR you IP address was blocked automatically by our firewall. Please contact us with your public IP address so we can check.

Sample Code

NOTE: Sample code removed

You can ask the AI Assistant in your account after login, it can generate code in any programming language for our API

Also, you can drop this document into any AI agent window (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini) and ask it to generate the code you need

Sample code can be found in your kwtSMS.com account

https://www.kwtsms.com/account/api/code/

Change Log

Date	Version	Description
2009-09-06	1.0	• First release
2020-10-15	2.0	• Added (Table of contents) page and reformatted the whole document with tables • Added error codes reference table/page
2023-02-01	2.5	• Added (dlr) HTTP API command • Added frequently asked questions (FAQ) page • Added more error codes
2023-04-01	3.0	• Added (Important Security Considerations) • Added Sample Code pages (PHP,Python,NODE.js) • Added this Change Log page • Updated new Account section, now you can request the API directly from the website. • Updated API Features section, added couple of new features • Update the FAQ page and revised some answers
2023-04-20	3.1	• Added test variable to the sender command • Added two new error codes for the send API call
2023-05-22	3.5	• Added JSON support to API • Removed all references to GET request. Use HTTP POST method only
2023-12-18	3.6	• Fixed typos in JSON send variables • Added “Implementation Best Practices” page • Added FAQ how to add new lines in text messages • Added FAQ getting weird codes when sending in Arabic
2024-01-25	3.7	• Updated kwtSMS API features • Removed references to using + in messages • Added new error code
2025-11-9	3.8	• Added new error codes • Added more “Implementation Best Practices”
2025-12-10	4.0	• Added (coverage,status,validate) API commands • Added important (Must know information) page • Updated (Implementation best practices) • Removed (Sample code)
2025-12-17	4.1	• Removed lang variable from sms sending (auto-detection) • Updated the /dlr/ command description